

Tianqi YANG

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Education

Bocconi University

MSc in Economic and Social Sciences (ESS)

2025–present

Milan, Italy

- IGIER–BIDSA Visiting Student.
- Current GPA: 29.82/30.

Wuhan University, Hongyi Honor College

BA in Philosophy, Politics and Economics (PPE)

2021–2025

Wuhan, China

- GPA: 3.93/4.

Research Interests

Political economy; economic history; state capacity; non-state governance.

Working Papers

Early Industrialization and the Rise of Secret Gangs in China, 1865–1949

Joint with Shijun He and Runnan Wang. Draft available upon request.

- Studies *secret gangs*, the sworn-brotherhood organizations of late Qing and Republican Chinese cities. They arose as substitutes for both the weak state and the village-based Confucian clans, supplying public goods to an urban underclass that neither could reach.
- Constructs three new historical datasets from archival sources: a Qing prefecture-year panel, a 200 m grid-cell cross-section of Republican Shanghai, and two internal Green Gang rosters. Uses an instrumental variable based on prefectures' exogenous coal endowments to identify the causal effect of industrialization.

Research Experience

Wuhan University

Research Assistant to Shijun He

2024–2025

Wuhan, China

- Cleaned and harmonized historical datasets; drafted portions of the manuscript.

Wuhan University

Research Assistant to Rufei Guo

2024–2025

Wuhan, China

- Cleaned and organized empirical datasets.

Other Experience

Wufeng Tujia Autonomous County

Government Intern, township and county offices

Summer 2022

Hubei, China

- Worked alongside township and county officials on village outreach, drafting of administrative materials, and routine field inspections.

Skills

Empirical and computing: Stata; R; Python; ArcGIS; QGIS; $\text{\LaTeX}$.

Languages: Chinese (native); English (fluent).

Honors and Scholarships

Wuhan University Outstanding Student Scholarship.

2021–2023

Hongyi Honor College Undergraduate Study Scholarship.

2021–2023

Training

Quantitative History Training Workshop, Yantai, China.

2025